STRATEGIC RESEARCH REPORT • RESEARCH SNAPSHOT: 6 NOVEMBER 2026

SecondShelf — Competitor Analysis & UX Benchmarking

Understanding the competitive landscape. Identifying defensible market gaps. Building a differentiated B2B inventory recovery network.

PROJECT: SECONDSHELF (LAGOSCATEGORY: B2B FOOD COMMERCE & TRACEABILITY PILOT)

TARGET REGION: MUSHIN & IDUMOTA MARKETS

1. Executive Summary & Core Research Discovery

This intelligence report synthesizes competitive desk research and product benchmarking conducted on **6 November 2026**. The primary strategic finding is that the food surplus and trade ecosystem comprises two distinct competitive layers:

Layer 1: Consumer Surplus Marketplaces
Platforms like PicksNCarts, PlentyDrop, and Ripe focus on connecting food merchants with individual consumers looking for discounted meals, groceries, and short-dated surprise packages.

Layer 2: B2B Procurement & Traceability
Platforms like Foodstuff Store, Discover Fresh (Vendease), and Trakiva capture wholesale commercial workflows, buyer trust, supply stability, credit facilities, and commodity verification.

The Strategic Opportunity for SecondShelf

Merely building a discounted retail marketplace is an overcrowded and insufficient differentiator. SecondShelf's defensible market space lies at the intersection of **distributor-first bulk inventory management, dynamic commercial buyer matching, structured food recovery routing, and immutable batch-level outcome records**.

2. SecondShelf Product Baseline & Evidence Standards

SecondShelf is structured around a four-stage operational cycle: `SCAN` → `SELL` → `RECOVER` → `PROVE`. To maintain strict research integrity, all claims in this document adhere to defined confidence classifications:

VERIFIED PUBLIC INFO
Documented on official competitor pages or verified news reports as of 6 Nov 2026.

HISTORICAL EVIDENCE
Archived recruitment or press materials requiring confirmation of current live status.

PROPOSED CAPABILITY
SecondShelf's intended MVP functionality, subject to pilot validation in Lagos.

Non-Negotiable Food Safety & Legal Guardrails:

- Expired food products can NEVER be listed, sold, or donated under any circumstance.
- Commercial sales performance and environmental recovery outcomes must remain strictly separated.
- No features should promise guaranteed carbon credits, automatic bank loans, or pre-certified outcomes.

3. Direct Competitor Analysis — Nigeria & Lagos Markets

Desk research identified four active or emerging direct competitors in the Lagos regional ecosystem, alongside one strategic watchlist company:

PicksNCarts (picksncarts.ng)

VERIFIED MARKETPLACE

Lagos-based digital commerce platform with three merchant sales models: regular sales, promotional sales, and surplus recovery **[PicksNCarts]**. Connects restaurants, bakeries, and stores with retail shoppers looking for discounted groceries and FMCG bulk offers.

Strategic Implication: Overlaps directly with surplus discovery. SecondShelf cannot claim to be Nigeria's first surplus food marketplace. However, PicksNCarts shows no established distributor-side expiry tracking, B2B negotiation tools, or charity matching.

PlentyDrop

WAITLIST / LAUNCHING

Lagos surplus marketplace connecting consumers with discounted groceries and meals **[PlentyDrop]**. Features a WhatsApp-powered merchant interaction flow and lightweight web dashboard.

Takeaway: Validates WhatsApp as a preferred, low-friction vendor communication channel.

Ripe

2026 ONBOARDING

Consumer-facing app focused on discounted unsold meals and groceries ("Discover → Reserve → Enjoy") **[Ripe]**. Onboarding initial business partners in Lagos.

Takeaway: Strong B2C consumer messaging; lacks wholesale distributor operations.

Klasma

EARLY ACCESS

Mobile-first, location-based food sharing platform connecting businesses, individuals, and NGOs/charities for surplus food redistribution **[Klasma]**.

Takeaway: Addresses donation access, but lacks bulk commercial matching tools.

Trakiva

STRATEGIC WATCHLIST

Currently positioned around commodity verification and trade finance **[Trakiva Main]**. However, historical recruitment materials explicitly detailed an *Expiry Recovery Network (ENRN)* targeting near-expiry FMCG stock **[Trakiva ENRN]**.

Takeaway: Critical entity to monitor due to potential overlap in trade traceability.

4. International Direct Benchmarks

Global benchmark platforms demonstrate mature operational models across inventory management, seller efficiency, and redistribution:

Too Good To Go

ENTERPRISE PLATFORM

Combines a consumer marketplace with an enterprise modular inventory suite featuring digital near-expiry tracking, dynamic markdowns, and integrated charity redistribution [Too Good To Go].

Lesson: Combining inventory management, sales, and donation is standard globally; execution speed is key.

Flashfood

SELLER EFFICIENCY

Retailer-facing app designed for rapid listing. Its May 2026 update allows store clerks to post up to 10 items in under 30 seconds using barcode and weighted-item scanning [Flashfood].

Lesson: Seller-side listing friction must be near zero for distributor adoption.

FoodCloud (Foodiverse)

RECOVERY WORKFLOW

Specialized technology powering charity surplus matching. Features explicit accept/decline flows, collection windows, waitlists, and warehouse hub logistics [FoodCloud].

Lesson: Donation matching is an explicit operational workflow, not just a marketplace toggle.

5. Indirect Competitors & Existing Market Alternatives

In Lagos markets like Mushin and Idumota, SecondShelf's primary competition is not just other apps, but deeply entrenched informal operational habits:

Alternative / Competitor	Existing Value Proposition	Strategic Implication for SecondShelf
Foodstuff Store [Foodstuff]	Bulk B2B procurement, credit facilities (FS Credit), quality checks, consolidated market delivery.	Buyers already expect verified supplier quality, credit access, and reliable delivery logistics.
Discover Fresh (Vendease) [Vendease]	Catalogue browsing, basket creation, WhatsApp order routing, secure link payment.	Proves that Lagos B2B buyers prefer fast, familiar WhatsApp ordering interactions.
WhatsApp & Phone Calls	Direct phone negotiations with known buyers; zero learning curve.	The real threat is a distributor saying "I already know who to call." SecondShelf must offer superior speed & auditability.
Physical Clearance Deals	Informal cash sales at extreme markdowns in open markets.	SecondShelf must prevent fire-sale margins (e.g. 69% losses) by enabling earlier 6-week markdown alerts.

6. Feature Comparison Matrix

Publicly documented capabilities across direct, benchmark, and indirect competitors (✓ = Documented · ◐ = Unclear / Partial · — = Not Established):

Platform	Expiry Control	Surplus Listing	B2B Bulk Match	Donation Route	Batch Audit Trail
SecondShelf PROPOSED	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
PicksNCarts [1]	◐	✓	◐	—	◐
PlentyDrop [2]	◐	✓	—	—	◐

Platform	Expiry Control	Surplus Listing	B2B Bulk Match	Donation Route	Batch Audit Trail
Ripe [3]	◐	✓	–	◐	◐
Klasma [4]	–	✓	–	✓	◐
Too Good To Go Enterprise [5]	✓	✓	–	✓	✓ / ◐
Flashfood [6]	✓	✓	–	–	✓ / ◐
FoodCloud [7]	◐	✓	–	✓	✓

Note: Absence of a feature in public documentation does not prove absence in private enterprise versions.

7. UX Benchmarking & Key Design Lessons

Flashfood — Fast Inventory Posting

Observed Pattern: Barcode scanning auto-fills product titles and categories, allowing store staff to list items rapidly.

SecondShelf UX Takeaway: Pre-fill product names via barcode lookup, but *always require manual confirmation of the printed expiry date*, as barcodes rarely store batch-specific dates.

Too Good To Go — Discovery & Filters

Observed Pattern: Map-based availability discovery with clear pickup time windows and instant reservation.

SecondShelf UX Takeaway: Provide B2B buyers with filters for minimum order quantity (MOQ), product category, remaining shelf-life days, and pickup market location.

FoodCloud — Explicit Handover Verification

Observed Pattern: Charity interface presents explicit offer deadlines, quantity accept/decline buttons, and scheduled collection slots.

SecondShelf UX Takeaway: A donation offer does not become a completed record upon claim; it requires two-sided digital confirmation upon physical handover.

Discover Fresh — WhatsApp Order Workflows

Observed Pattern: Web catalogue allows users to build a cart and seamlessly transition to WhatsApp to finalize payment links and delivery.

SecondShelf UX Takeaway: Integrate WhatsApp notification triggers and order summaries to match existing Lagos market trading habits.

8. Market Gap Analysis & Defensible Opportunities

Gap 03: Separate Commercial & Recovery

Explicit dual-path workflow: Commercial sale is prioritized first. If unsold prior to critical threshold, stock transitions to verified food banks for timely donation.

Gap 01: Distributor-First Bulk Focus

Existing local competitors focus on retail consumers. SecondShelf targets wholesale distributors in Mushin & Idumota moving full cases and pallets to commercial buyers (canteens, retailers).

Gap 02: 6-Week Expiry Radar

Rather than clearance in the final week at a 69% loss, SecondShelf flags stock 6 weeks early, suggesting structured 20–35% markdowns while products retain high commercial value.

Gap 04: Food Safety & Anti-Repackaging Protection

A April 2026 *BusinessDay* investigation highlighted severe food safety risks in Nigeria, where expired or near-expiry foods are stripped of packaging and resold illegally **[BusinessDay]**. SecondShelf enforces batch-level tracking, original packaging verification, and strict registration rules to guarantee food integrity.

9. Strategic Positioning & Messaging Architecture

PROPOSED POSITIONING STATEMENT

"SecondShelf is a B2B inventory recovery and traceability network that helps food distributors identify at-risk stock, reach suitable commercial buyers, route eligible food to recovery partners, and record what happens to every batch."

Competitor Category	Their Primary Focus	SecondShelf's Differentiation
Consumer Surplus Apps	Individual surprise bags & retail deals	Bulk commercial cartons & wholesale B2B distribution
Donation Networks	Purely charitable redistribution	Commercial sale first; structured charity recovery as fallback
B2B Procurement	Standard replenishment stock	Time-sensitive near-expiry stock recovery & markdown pricing
Commodity Traceability	Upstream agricultural provenance	Downstream inventory expiry monitoring & batch audit records

10. MVP Feature Prioritization & Core User Journeys

To ensure success during the hackathon and initial 30-distributor Lagos pilot, capabilities are strictly prioritized:

P0 — CRITICAL MVP

- Distributor & buyer onboarding
- Barcode scan & manual expiry input
- 6-Week Smart Expiry Radar dashboard
- B2B Markdown Marketplace listings
- Order placement & status tracking
- Two-sided delivery handover confirmation
- Immutable batch outcome record

P1 — PILOT EXTENSION

- Verified charity donation matching
- Basic business passport summary
- Admin evidence review dashboard
- Automated WhatsApp notification alerts

DEFERRED FOR FUTURE

- Complex AI demand/price forecasting
- LinkedIn-style social networking feed
- Automated bank loan underwriting
- Carbon credit brokerage marketplace
- Native iOS/Android mobile apps

Core End-to-End User Journey (Commercial Route):

`Distributor Scans Batch → Expiry Radar Flags Urgency → Listed on B2B Marketplace → Buyer Submits Offer → Terms Agreed → Handover Confirmed (Photo/GPS) → Batch Record Archived (Business Passport)`

11. Competitive Risk Analysis & Mitigation Strategy

Risk 1: Two-Sided Marketplace Liquidity

Distributors will stop listing if buyers do not respond rapidly.

Mitigation: Focus the pilot on 30 specific distributors and 100 pre-onboarded canteens/retailers in Mushin to guarantee immediate buyer liquidity.

Risk 2: Resistance to Changing Phone/WhatsApp Habits

Traders prefer direct phone calls over navigating complex web forms.

Mitigation: Keep listing creation under 30 seconds and allow order updates via automated WhatsApp messages.

12. User Validation Plan & Success Metrics

Qualitative research targets for validating user workflows prior to full pilot deployment:

6–8
Distributor Interviews (Mushin/Idumota)

5–6
Commercial Buyer Discovery Tests

3–4
Food Bank & Charity Interviews

5–6
Prototype Usability Teardowns

Commercial Success Metrics

- Listing Creation Time: < 45 seconds per batch.
- Time to First Qualified Buyer Offer: < 24 hours.
- % of Listed Stock Sold Prior to Expiry Date: Target > 60%.
- Distributor Revenue Recovery vs Fire Sale: 2x baseline.

Recovery & Traceability Metrics

- Handover Confirmation Rate: 100% two-sided photo proof.
- Completeness of Batch Outcome Audit Records: 100%.
- Unsold Wholesome Stock Route to Charity: 100% before expiry.
- Zero Post-Expiry Transactions Enforced.

13. Strategic Recommendations & References

Final Strategic Summary for Hackathon & Product Build

Do not build another generic food-waste app or retail discount catalogue. Position SecondShelf as the **B2B inventory recovery network** for Lagos food distributors. Focus the hackathon build on an ultra-fast listing flow, clear 6-week expiry prioritization, low-friction buyer matching, and verifiable batch outcome tracking.

Research Snapshot Primary References (Checked 6 Nov 2026):

1. PicksNCarts Nigeria — Official Digital Commerce & Surplus Recovery Platform: **picksncarts.ng**
2. PlentyDrop Lagos — Save More, Waste Less Surplus Marketplace: **plentydrop.com**
3. Ripe Africa — Discounted Unsold Meals & Groceries: **ripe.africa**
4. Klasma App — Location-Based Food Sharing & Donation Network: **klasmaapp.com**
5. Trakiva — Commodity Verification & Trade Finance Infrastructure: **gettrakiva.com**
6. Trakiva Historical Expiry Recovery Network (ENRN) Recruitment Documentation (Lagos).
7. Too Good To Go Enterprise Surplus Management Platform: **toogoodtogo.com**
8. Flashfood Retailer App & Rapid Barcode Scanning Benchmark (May 2026 Release): **flashfood.com**
9. FoodCloud Foodiverse Surplus Redistribution Technology: **food.cloud**
10. Foodstuff Store Nigeria — B2B Food Procurement & FS Credit: **foodstuff.store**
11. Discover Fresh by Vendease — B2B Procurement Workflow: **dscvrfrsh.com**
12. BusinessDay Nigeria — Investigation into Food Safety & Repackaged Near-Expiry Sales (17 April 2026).